

A.D. 1620. And yf the Offenders or Persons charged or suspected to have offended as aforefaid shall refuse to perform your said Orders in manner and form aforefaid, or to give Bonds to Our Use for the performance of the said Orders as aforefaid, then it shall and may be lawful for you, or any three or more of you as is aforefaid, and we do give unto you, or any three or more of you as is aforefaid, by these Presents, full Power and Authority in that behalf to punish them and every of them by reasonable Imprisonment according to your Discretions.

And further we doe give unto you, or any three or more of you as is aforefaide, full Power and Authority to take and seize; or cause to be taken or seized such Children and other Persons which from tyme to tyme shall be carryed or conveyed, or ready to be carryed or conveyed into any the Parts beyond the Seas, to the Intente to be there brought upp in Romish Religion as aforefaide, and likewise to take and seize, or cause to be taken and seised, such Money and other Things which shall be appointed to be carried or conveyed into any the Parts beyond the Seas, to and for Mayntenance either of the said Children and other Persons soe carryed, or ready to be carried and conveyed as aforefaid, or of any other Person or Persons brought upp or remayning in the foresaide Semynaries or Schooles of Romish Religion, and the said Children and other Persons, which shall be taken as is aforefaid, to deteyne them in safe Custody till some good Order may be taken for them.

And alsoe we doe give unto you; or any such three or more of you as is aforefaid, full Power and Authority to seize or cause to be seized all massing Stuff Reliques or other like superstitious things, and to deface the same, and cause them to be defaced in such manner as from thenceforth they may not serve for any superstitious Use, without destroyeing the Substance thereof except otherwise it cannot be defaced.

And forasmuch as, since our last Commission for Causes Ecclesiastical graunted under our Greate Seale of England to some of you and others, there hath been divers lamentable Complaynts and Petitions delivered, as well to our selfe as to our Privy Councell, by many Wives against Husbands wherein they have suggested that without any just Cause of Offence

given by them to their said Husbands in that behalfe, and notwithstanding that some of them have brought to their Husbands great Advancements, Yet, by their Husbands cruell and barbarous Usage and Breach of the Bonds of holy Wedlocke and other their ungodly Demeanors, they have bene either cast of or left by their Husbands, or forced to fly from them or leave their Cohabitation without fit Mayntenance given unto them; and that the Ordinary Ecclesiasticall Courts did not afford them timely and fit meanes of Relief for sundry Reasons, and especially because their Necessities require above all other Cases of Grievance a summarie Hearinge, and speedy Reliefe being otherwise often in Danger to perish for Want; we therefore, to th'End that, as well our self as our Privy Councell daily ymployed in the highest Affaires of State, might be freed of this particular, and alsoe that the just Complaynts and distressed Estates of such Wives, in the Cases aforefaid, may be with all convenient Expedition heard determyned and relieved in a certayne Court whereunto in that behalfe they may ordinarily repayer for Justice; doe give unto you, and every three or more of you as is aforefaid, full Power and Authority by these Presents in that behalfe, uppon every such Complaynt made unto you, or any such three or more of you as is aforefaid, in all and every the Cases aforefaid, by any Wife, or in the behalfe of any Wife against her Husband to send for by Letters missive, or to cause to be apprehended and brought before you, or any such three or more of you as is aforefaid, by Proces of Attachment yf neede be in Manner and Form aforefaid, all and every such Husbands which, either by their cruell and barbarous Usage, or by the Breach of the Bonds of holy Wedlock or other their ungodly Demeanor, have or shall cast of or leave their Wives, or force or give their Wives just Cause to flye from them or leave their Cohabitation. And when any such Husband or Husbands so offendinge, or charged or accused as aforefaid to have offended in the Cases aforementioned, shall appeare or be brought before you, or any such three or more of you as is aforefaide, to proccede to the Examination thereof by all and every the lawful Waies and Meanes before mencioned with all convenient expedition, according to the grave Wisedomes and Discre-